# COMP 110 and COMP 110L

Introduction to Algorithms and Programming

Fall 2026 | California State University Northridge

This syllabus explains what you will learn, how coursework is evaluated, and how to get help. Use Canvas for assignments, deadlines, announcements, and grades.

Revised October 28 2026

## Instructor and course meetings

Instructor: Bahram Zartoshty

Email Bahram Zartoshty at bzartoshty@csun.edu

Instructor website

• COMP 110 lecture, section 15999: Monday and Wednesday, 8:30-9:45 AM, Jacaranda 1107.

• COMP 110L lab, section 16000: Monday and Wednesday, 10:00-11:15 AM, Jacaranda 1107.

• Class dates: August 24-December 11, 2026.

• Office hours: Monday and Wednesday, 12:45-2:00 PM, JD 4442.

### Final exam

COMP 110 section 15999: date and time to be announced according to the university final exam schedule. Location: Jacaranda 1107.

You are required to take the final exam. If an emergency prevents you from taking it, contact me as soon as possible. A missed final is subject to the make-up policy and university grading rules. A WU is assigned only when university criteria for unauthorized withdrawal are met; it counts as an F in GPA calculations.

## Office Hours

Location: JD 4442
Office Hours: Monday/Wednesday, 12:45 PM – 2:00 PM

## Communication Policy

Use email for course-related messages. Keep messages focused and begin the subject line with COMP 110 Question.

Many technical questions are best handled during lecture or lab because the entire class may benefit from the discussion.

I generally respond to email within 24 hours on academic days.

When emailing, always include:

• Your full name

• Your course and section

• Your CSUN email address

Messages from unfamiliar personal email addresses may be difficult to identify.

## Course Description

This course introduces algorithms, including their representation, design, structure, analysis, and optimization. Students will implement algorithms as structured programs using a high-level programming language.

The course focuses on problem solving, algorithmic thinking, and Java programming. Students will learn how to analyze problems, design algorithmic solutions, and translate those solutions into executable Java programs.

Java is the programming language for this course. You must demonstrate skill in both problem solving and Java programming to complete the course successfully.

The lecture component, COMP 110, emphasizes concepts, examples, and problem-solving techniques. The lab component, COMP 110L, emphasizes developing, testing, and debugging working Java applications.

No previous programming experience is assumed. The course moves quickly and requires regular practice. It is designed for students in Computer Science and related majors who need practical programming skills.

## Course Goals

You will learn to analyze problems, develop algorithms, translate them into Java programs, and apply the basic software development process.

Although Java is the programming language used in this course, the problem-solving and algorithmic skills developed in the course are not specific to any one programming language.

## Learning outcomes

A successful student will be able to:

• Demonstrate basic knowledge of computers, operating systems, editing, compiling, and running programs.

• Translate human-readable algorithms represented by pseudocode, flowcharts, or flow-block diagrams into Java.

• Write and test Java programs using the four fundamental programming structures: sequence, choice, loops, and methods.

• Construct programs that use multiple methods and parameter passing.

• Demonstrate knowledge of the basic software development process: problem statement, program development, testing, and documentation.

• Solve problems using one-dimensional and two-dimensional arrays.

• Use basic sorting and searching methods.

• Apply the Java String class.

• Read from and write to text files.

• Demonstrate practical use of exception handling.

• Recognize the role of object-oriented programming in software development.

• Run and modify examples and exercises studied in the course.

• Explain the basic concepts of inheritance and polymorphism.

## Prerequisites

A grade of C- or better in one of the following courses:

• MATH 102

• MATH 103

• MATH 104

• MATH 105

• MATH 150A

• MATH 255A

Or a passing score on the Math Placement Test that satisfies the prerequisite for MATH 150A or MATH 255A.

### Corequisite

COMP 110L is a corequisite for COMP 110.

## Course Materials

Most course resources, including slides and code examples, will be posted on:

COMP 110 slides and code examples

Assignments, grades, and announcements will be available on Canvas:

CSUN Canvas course Assignments and grades

Grades will also be posted on Canvas.

Submit questions about lab or exam grades within two days of the grade being posted. After that period, posted grades are final for routine course review. This deadline does not replace university grade appeal procedures or approved accommodations.

### Required Textbook

This course uses a required interactive e-textbook through Pearson Revel:

Liang, Introduction to Java Programming and Data Structures, 13th edition

To access the course materials:

1. Go to Canvas.

2. Select Access Pearson, or go to the Revel assignments under Modules.

3. Open the assignment titled 1: Introduction to Computers, Programs, and Java.

## Required Software and Technology

You need regular, reliable access to a computer and the internet. If access is a barrier, contact me early so we can discuss available campus support.

Students may complete coursework on a personal laptop. Lab machines use Linux, but the required software is available for Windows, macOS, and Linux.

You must install:

• Java Development Kit — JDK

• A Java editor or IDE

You may use any editor or IDE you prefer. Suggested options include:

• jGRASP

• IntelliJ IDEA

• Other Java-compatible IDEs or editors

Install the Java Development Kit (JDK), not only the Java Runtime Environment (JRE). Install the JDK before configuring your editor or IDE. Follow the course setup instructions for the required JDK version.

Oracle Java Development Kit downloads

jGRASP editor downloads

IntelliJ IDEA downloads

## Course Format

Lectures will use instructor PowerPoint slides, Revel materials, and coding examples.

Students are expected to attend lecture and lab regularly. Reading the material alone is not a substitute for participating in class discussions, viewing demonstrations, and practicing programming during lab sessions.

Revel assignments will provide interactive learning activities and will be graded.

## Exams

There will be a Midterm Exam and a Final Exam.

Exams will be based on material presented in lecture, lab, the textbook, assignments, and programming examples.

The Midterm and Final Exam may include:

• Multiple-choice questions

• Code-reading questions

• Short programming or code-writing questions

Exams are closed book. You may bring one sheet of notes with writing on both sides. No other notes or aids are permitted unless explicitly authorized or provided through an approved accommodation.

During exams, I will not define course terminology or explain concepts being assessed. You may ask about procedural instructions or report a suspected error in a question.

## Lab Assignments

All labs and projects are graded programming assignments.

Expect frequent lab assignments, typically two or three per week. The number may vary with the pace of the class.

Lab assignments are designed to reinforce lecture topics and help students master fundamental programming techniques, algorithms, and problem-solving strategies.

There are two main types of lab assignments:

### Revel Labs

Revel Labs are completed inside Pearson Revel. These assignments are auto-graded and are connected to specific textbook chapters.

### IDE Labs

IDE Labs are completed using a programming environment such as jGRASP or IntelliJ. These assignments require students to demonstrate mastery of course concepts by designing, coding, testing, and documenting Java programs.

IDE Lab submissions must include:

• Requirements

• Input

• Output

• Source code listing

• Completed documentation form submitted as a Word file on Canvas

• Java source file uploaded separately as a .java file

## Programming Environment

Java programming will be practiced during lab sessions. Students will use the Java Development Kit and an IDE.

Students will learn how to:

• Edit Java source code

• Compile programs

• Run programs

• Debug programs

• Use IDE tools

• Generate Code Structure Diagrams

• Generate basic UML class diagrams

• Run programs in debug mode

Lab sessions will usually include explanation of assignments, starter code, related examples, and time for students to work on programming tasks.

Students should expect to spend time outside of lab completing assignments and projects.

## Generative AI and independent work

Generative AI is prohibited on all graded work unless I explicitly authorize it in writing for that assignment. This includes Revel activities, labs, projects, documentation, quizzes, and exams. The rule covers chatbots, AI code completion, code generation, AI debugging, and AI rewriting tools, whether used directly or built into an editor or IDE.

### What the rule means

• Do not ask AI to solve, outline, write, complete, debug, translate, or rewrite any part of a graded task unless the assignment explicitly permits it.

• Do not paste assignment prompts, starter code, test questions, or your graded-work code into an AI tool. Do not submit AI-generated code, pseudocode, explanations, test cases, or documentation as your own work.

• Disable generative AI features when doing graded work. Ordinary non-generative editor features, such as syntax highlighting, compilation, and standard debugging, remain permitted unless an assessment says otherwise.

• You may use AI for ungraded study of general concepts or unrelated practice problems. Keep that activity separate from graded assignments and verify explanations against course materials.

### When an assignment authorizes AI

Follow the written limits for that assignment. Identify the tool and model if available, the date, the prompts you used, and how you used the output. Include the relevant interaction or an excerpt as directed. Explain what you verified and changed. You remain responsible for accuracy, testing, citations, and understanding every submitted line of code.

Example disclosure for an authorized activity: I used [tool and model] on [date] with the prompt [prompt]. I used the output to [purpose], verified it by [tests or course references], and changed [specific changes].

### Privacy and access

Do not upload personal information, grades, passwords, private student work, or course materials you lack permission to share. No paid AI subscription is required. If an authorized activity requires AI and you cannot access or use the tool, contact me before the deadline to arrange an equivalent way to meet the learning goal.

Screen readers, speech input, and other assistive technologies are not prohibited by this policy. If a tool also generates answers or code, discuss the relevant function with me and DRES or NCOD so approved accommodations can be implemented without ambiguity.

If you are unsure whether a feature is permitted, ask before using it on graded work. Unauthorized use is handled under the academic integrity policy below.

## Collaboration Policy

Collaboration among students is encouraged, but students must not copy code from one another.

Discussing ideas, problem-solving strategies, and general approaches is acceptable. Copying code, submitting another person’s work, or allowing another student to submit your work is plagiarism.

In programming, there may sometimes be limited ways to solve a particular problem. This will be taken into consideration. However, each student is still responsible for writing and understanding their own submitted work.

## Late Submission Policy

All assignments and labs will have due dates.

Late labs and assignments are not accepted after the due date, except as provided through approved accommodations or an approved emergency arrangement.

Submit assignments through Canvas. If Canvas is unavailable, email your assignment to me as a last resort and describe the access problem.

## Grading

Students will receive one combined grade for COMP 110 and COMP 110L.

Use the weights below to estimate your course grade. Canvas is used to post scores.

Each category grade is based on the sum of points earned divided by the sum of points possible within that category. Overall percentage = 0.25 × Revel percentage + 0.25 × lab percentage + 0.25 × midterm percentage + 0.25 × final exam percentage.

| Category | Weight |
|---|---|
| Revel Assignments | 25% |
| Lab Assignments | 25% |
| Midterm Exam | 25% |
| Final Exam | 25% |
| Total | 100% |

### Letter Grade Scale

Plus/minus grading is used. Each threshold below is a minimum percentage. The highest letter grade whose threshold you meet will be assigned.

For example, a score of 88.2% earns a B+ because it is greater than or equal to 86.5%.

| Minimum Score | Letter Grade |
|---|---|
| 92.5 | A |
| 89.5 | A- |
| 86.5 | B+ |
| 82.5 | B |
| 79.5 | B- |
| 76.5 | C+ |

| Minimum Score | Letter Grade |
|---|---|
| 72.5 | C |
| 69.5 | C- |
| 66.5 | D+ |
| 62.5 | D |
| 59.5 | D- |
| 0 | F |

## Make-Up Policy

Make-up exams are not guaranteed. Request a make-up before the scheduled exam whenever possible. If an emergency prevents advance notice, contact me as soon as possible. Requests are subject to instructor approval and applicable university requirements and approved accommodations.

There will be no make-up quizzes.

Missed projects, quizzes, or exams without prior approval or a documented emergency may not be made up.

An Incomplete is intended for qualifying medical or other documented emergencies, not to catch up on missed work. Eligibility and arrangements are governed by current CSUN policy; contact me promptly to discuss your circumstances.

## Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is a core value of the university community. It is essential for maintaining the quality of higher education, developing critical thinking skills, and ensuring that academic achievements are based on merit.

Academic dishonesty includes any practice or behavior, whether intentional or unintentional, that undermines the integrity of work submitted for academic credit. Common forms of academic dishonesty include plagiarism, cheating, and fraud.

### Plagiarism

Plagiarism includes presenting someone else's work as your own or using it without appropriate acknowledgment. Unauthorized AI-generated material is also prohibited. Disclosure does not make an otherwise prohibited use permissible.

Self-plagiarism is also prohibited. Self-plagiarism includes resubmitting the same work from another class without the current instructor’s knowledge and approval.

### Cheating

Examples of cheating include, but are not limited to:

• Copying from another student’s quiz or exam

• Using unauthorized materials during an exam, including phones, smart watches, browsers, or notes beyond the one permitted sheet

• Unauthorized collaboration or communication during a quiz or exam

• Downloading, uploading, sharing, or duplicating course materials without permission

• Unauthorized use of generative AI tools, Stack Overflow, Chegg, Course Hero, Quizlet, or similar resources during quizzes or exams

### Fraud

Examples of fraud include, but are not limited to:

• Having someone else complete a quiz or exam for you

• Buying, selling, or obtaining quizzes or exams improperly

• Falsifying or forging academic records or supporting documents

• Submitting a fake doctor's note

• Misrepresenting your identity

• Improperly accessing or obstructing course materials or systems

• Falsely claiming participation in a class activity

Suspected academic dishonesty may be referred to Student Conduct. University procedures govern the review and any disciplinary action.

CSUN Student Conduct resources

### COMP 110 Policy on Academic Dishonesty

Academic dishonesty may result in one or more of the following consequences:

• A grade of 0 on the assignment or examination

• A grade of 0 for the entire course

• Referral of the incident to the Office of the Vice President for Student Affairs

## Accessibility and Student Support Resources

Use the campus resources below for accommodations and support. Contact me if a course file, video, assignment, or software tool creates an access barrier. Describe the material and the barrier; you do not need to include medical details in your email.

Course student support resource guide

### Students with Disabilities

Students who need disability-related accommodations should register with Disability Resources and Educational Services (DRES) or NCOD Deaf and Hard of Hearing Services, as appropriate. Request and manage approved course accommodations each term through the Student Access and Accommodation System (SAAS). Contact the relevant office early about exam arrangements and alternate formats.

DRES: Bayramian Hall 110; 818-677-2684; dres@csun.edu.

NCOD Deaf and Hard of Hearing Services: Jeanne Chisholm Hall; 818-677-2054; ncod@csun.edu.

Contact me privately to discuss implementation of approved accommodations. If an accommodation or course technology is not working, notify me and the relevant support office promptly. Approved accommodations apply to course participation, assessment, and deadlines as appropriate.

DRES registration and accommodation procedures

NCOD Deaf and Hard of Hearing Services

When reporting an inaccessible document or video, identify the file or link and the format or support you need, such as readable text, captions, or a description of a diagram. For programming submissions, provide selectable text in the Word documentation form and submit the .java source separately. Do not replace required source code with screenshots.

Use meaningful headings and labels in documentation. If you include a diagram, add a brief text explanation. Describe errors in words as well as providing any screenshot. Ask for help if the documentation template or an assigned platform is not accessible.

## Attendance

Attendance will not be monitored closely. However, scheduled lecture and lab times are the best opportunities to ask questions, receive help, and participate in discussions.

Regular participation helps you keep up with demonstrations and practice. If you miss class, review the posted materials and ask focused questions during office hours or by email. Contact me if an access barrier or other circumstance affects your participation.

Students should attend lecture to participate in discussions and attend lab to receive programming help.

## Changes to the Syllabus

Changes to the syllabus or course plan will be announced in class and through email or Canvas. Revised syllabi will include the revision date. Any change to permitted AI use will be communicated in writing before it applies to the affected work.

Students are responsible for keeping up with all course announcements.

## Tentative Course Topics

This tentative sequence may change. Assignment deadlines appear in Canvas. Midterm timing and the final exam date and time will be announced separately.

| Week | Topics |
|---|---|
| 1 | Introduction to Computers, Programs, and Java |
| 2 | Elementary Programming |
| 3 | Selections |
| 4 | Mathematical Functions and Characters |
| 5 | Loops |
| 6 | More Loops |

| Week | Topics |
|---|---|
| 7 | Single-Dimensional Arrays |
| 8 | Multi-Dimensional Arrays |
| 9 | Methods, Searching, and Sorting |
| 10 | Objects and Classes |
| 11 | Thinking in Objects |
| 12 | Inheritance and Polymorphism |
| 13 | Exception Handling |
| 14 | Text I/O, time permitting |
| 15 | Interfaces, time permitting |

## University policy references

These university resources provide additional context for the course policies and accommodation process.

CSUN Artificial Intelligence Course Policy and Withdrawal Unauthorized policy

CSUN syllabus requirements